THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 23: **The Ball Poem (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** John Berryman	An American poet.
2	**(d)** learn to stand up and bear the loss	Accept loss.
3	**(c)** deep and silent	Quiet grief.
4	**(a)** lost his ball	A loss.
5	**(b)** childhood and the things we lose	Symbolic of loss.
6	**(c)** loss is part of growing up	Message.
7	**(d)** water	It fell into the harbour.
8	**(b)** sympathetic and thoughtful	Understanding.
9	**(c)** loss and growing up	Theme.
10	**(a)** an observer of the scene	He watches.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It bounced down the street (1) and rolled into the water of the harbour (1).	1+1
12	He is learning about loss (1) and responsibility (1).	1+1
13	Sympathetic (1) and reflective (1).	1+1
14	He stands helpless at the water's edge (1) overcome by grief (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	A boy plays with a ball (1). It bounces into the harbour (1). He stands still, staring at the water (1).	1+1+1
16	A deep, trembling sorrow (1). The boy is shaken (1). It feels complete (1).	1+1+1
17	It cannot buy back feelings (1). It is external (1). It does not teach loss (1).	1+1+1
	OR: The boy loves this ball (1). Another ball cannot replace it (1). He is learning a deeper truth (1).	1+1+1
18	It stands for childhood joy (1). Its loss stands for early disappointment (1). It leads to the idea of growing up (1).	1+1+1
	OR: The poet said that it was no use saying there were other balls (1). Tense backshifts (1). The main clause is preserved (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Boy loses ball (1). Grief (1). Poet's reflection (1). Money cannot replace (1). Loss teaches growth (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Intro (1). The loss (1). Feelings (1). Lesson (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
20	Ball rolls into the harbour (1). Boy stands helpless (1). Poet observes (1). Refuses to buy another (1). Boy learns (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Both short (1). Ball: loss (1). Snow: relief (1). Tone (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that the ball is the main subject; it is a **symbol of loss** and the poem is about learning to cope with loss.
- Saying the poet will buy him another ball and all will be well; the poet says that **money cannot replace** the feeling of loss.
- Missing the idea: the boy begins to understand **responsibility** in a world of possessions where things get lost.
- Giving the wrong setting: the ball rolls down the steps and into the **harbour**, where it is lost for good.
- Mixing the poet: **John Berryman**, an American poet; the poem is in blank (unrhymed) verse with *enjambment*.
- Spelling slips: *responsibility, harbour, possession, loss, ball poem*.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 23: **The Ball Poem (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** serious and reflective	Reflective.
2	**(c)** compassion	Sympathy.
3	**(d)** bouncing down the street	It bounced merrily.
4	**(a)** a sheltered port	A port.
5	**(b)** The ball was lost by the boy.	Past passive.
6	**(d)** helpless at the water's edge	Staring at the water.
7	**(d)** to enter where one is not wanted	Interfere.
8	**(d)** gain	Loss x gain.
9	**(a)** that there are other balls	It will not console him.
10	**(d)** learning that things can be lost	Understanding value.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Money cannot fill the inner loss (1) so it is outside real feeling (1).	1+1
12	Childhood and treasured things (1) which may be lost (1).	1+1
13	It is no use saying there are other balls (1) because he feels the loss deeply (1).	1+1
14	Loss is part of growing up (1) and one must learn to stand up after it (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Loss is seen as painful (1). It is also a teacher (1). It helps the boy grow (1).	1+1+1
16	First part describes the event (1). Second part reflects (1). The shift gives depth (1).	1+1+1
17	Her grief was silent (1). Do not intrude on his privacy (1). Both words are used correctly (1).	1+1+1
	OR: People own things (1). They can lose them (1). He learns to be responsible (1).	1+1+1
18	The harbour is wide and deep (1). It makes the ball unreachable (1). It adds to the boy's helplessness (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Accept loss (1). Be strong (1). Value things but not too much (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Loss as experience (1). Boy's grief (1). Poet's view (1). Responsibility (1). Message (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Greeting (1). Poem (1). Examples (1). Advice (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
20	Theme (1). Imagery (1). Tone (1). Language (1). Opinion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Easy words (1). Daily scene (1). Symbolism (1). Reflection (1). Effect (1).	2+2+1

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- Missing the idea: the boy begins to understand **responsibility** in a world of possessions where things get lost.
- Giving the wrong setting: the ball rolls down the steps and into the **harbour**, where it is lost for good.
- Mixing the poet: **John Berryman**, an American poet; the poem is in blank (unrhymed) verse with *enjambment*.
- Spelling slips: *responsibility, harbour, possession, loss, ball poem*.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 23: **The Ball Poem (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** sorrow	Sorrow.
2	**(c)** not offer to buy him another ball	He will not intrude.
3	**(a)** how one learns the meaning of loss	Knowing through loss.
4	**(c)** into	Into the water.
5	**(c)** loss and responsibility	A lesson in grief.
6	**(c)** near water	At the harbour.
7	**(c)** replace the loss with money	He rejects the idea.
8	**(b)** external and cannot replace real loss	Money cannot fix everything.
9	**(a)** first person	Poet says 'I'.
10	**(c)** how to face loss	Reflection.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	John Berryman (1) an American poet (1).	1+1
12	Money cannot replace the loss (1) and the boy must learn to bear it (1).	1+1
13	He will face many losses (1) so he must learn to be strong (1).	1+1
14	He watches silently (1) and refuses to give false comfort (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	He respects the boy's grief (1). Any gift would be false comfort (1). The boy must face it himself (1).	1+1+1
16	It deals with loss (1). It teaches resilience (1). It uses a simple event (1).	1+1+1
17	Listen (1). Do not belittle the loss (1). Offer support, not just gifts (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He understands grief (1). He avoids easy answers (1). He sees loss as part of life (1).	1+1+1
18	Silent grief (1). The simple image of the boy at the water (1). The refusal of false comfort (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Loss is universal (1). The language is simple (1). The message is true (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Address (1). Greeting (1). Sympathy (1). Advice (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Greeting (1). Question (1). Answer (1). Comfort (1).	2+2+1
20	Date (1). The game (1). The loss (1). Feelings (1). Lesson (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Intro (1). Poem's view (1). Examples (1). Counterpoint (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

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